

Pari-mutuel Competition-World Cup 2026 Edition

What is it?

A pari-mutuel system is one that places all bets of a type together – in the case of our Pari-mutuel pool, your bets will establish your “ownership” of various teams as they progress through the tournament. Those teams, should they win games, will collect points along the way and you will collect your percentage of those points that your team wins. The guy (or gal) with the most points at the end of the tourney is the winner. It is a way more fun approach to betting on tournaments where picking the final champion is not the only deciding factor in winning the competition. Here’s how it will work.

What do I do?

You will contribute \$25-\$100 to the pool, which will give you the ability to invest in increments of \$1 – no fractions, please – to as many or as few teams as you wish. You may invest \$25 in France, or \$1 in 25 different teams, and anything in between. This will be done on a completely blind basis (ie – no one will know what anyone else has invested until the investing is done).

How does the investing work?

Based on the pari-mutuel system, you will “own” a percentage of each team based on how many total dollars were invested by all of the participants in the pool. If you were the only \$1 investor in Senegal, congratulations! You own 100% of Senegal. If you invested \$25 in France and four other people did the same, you own 20% of France ($\$25/\$125=20\%$).

So how does scoring work?

Scoring in this system is driven by the value of elimination games after the Group Stage, which is quite simply the sum of the values of the two teams involved. Each game is winner-take-all, which means that the owners of a team share in the points from that victory.

Example: Senegal vs. France

Let’s say with our above example that Senegal came into the game with France,¹ and had a value of 1 point. This value was set by the fact that only one person bid \$1 to own them. France, on the other hand, came in with a value of 125, as five people bid on them. The total point value for this game is 126.

If France wins this game, each of the owners of France split that 126 points based on their ownership. So a 20% owner would get 25.2 points from this victory.

If, on the other hand, Senegal pulled off a miracle, the single, solitary owner of Senegal would take home all 126 points from the victory!

Here’s the kicker, though – the team that wins carries that point value to the next round. So regardless of whether Senegal or France win the game, when they advance to the next round, the winning team now brings 126 points to the game’s value. This continues throughout the tournament.

How does that work with the World Cup ‘26 round structure?

There will be six opportunities to score points, beginning with the teams who are able to advance out of their group.

¹ Note: This example won’t happen because Senegal and France are in the same Group, so they can only face each other in the finals. Only illustrative.

Group Stage Scoring

Scoring will begin once teams get out of the Group Stage. At that point, 32 teams will advance, leaving 16 other teams behind. There are 12 groups of 4. Please note in this World Cup, the best 8 of the 12 third place teams will make it along with the top 2 from each group.

Here's how the Out of Group Scoring will work: the two teams advancing from each group will share the points of the teams that did not advance. Let's look at Group I and assume that both France and Senegal advance, these teams will share the points of Norway and Iraq, the other teams in their Group. Using our above example, if Norway and Iraq both had a value of, say, 20, Senegal and France would each earn their own value plus an equal share of the losers' 40 points. Group I would have a total point value of 166 (125 for France, 1 for Senegal, 20 for Norway and 20 for Iraq). So Senegal owners would earn 21 points, while France owners would earn 145. That would also be the value that Senegal and France would take into their Round of 32 games. In the case of groups where three teams make it, the three teams will equally share the points of the bottom team.

Scoring after the Group Stage

After this, the scoring system described above would prevail. Every team wins and accumulates points based on its victories, giving its points to its owners in every round.

Walking through the tournament with France

Let's just assume that France wins the tournament. Here's how it might be scored. Remember that points aren't scored during the actual Group Stage – only the teams that advance from the Group Stage will earn points!

1.) **Group Stage:** France advances with Senegal. The Group I losers – Norway and Iraq– have values of 20, which France and Senegal share/split equally.

- Points earned by France in this Round: 145 (France 125 + share of Norway and Iraq)
- If you own 20% of France, you would earn 29 points that round from France.
- Cumulative Points earned by you from France: 29 points

2.) **Round of 32:** France tops the group and faces off with a 3rd place team from Group C/D/F/G/H– let's say Scotland makes it through from Group C as one of the third-place teams. Scotland comes into the game with 40 points – its original value plus its share of Group C losers' points. France wins!

- Points earned by France in this Round: 185
- If you own 20% of France, you would earn 37 points that round from France.
- Cumulative Points earned by you from France: 66 points

3.) **Round of 16:** France vs Germany, an early clash of titans. Germany topped Group E easily, cruised through their match in Boston and comes into the game with 110 points – its original value plus its share of Group E losers' points and their R32 winnings. France overcomes and is victorious! They earn the sum total of its points plus those earned by Germany (185 + 110=295)

- Points earned by France in this Round: 295
- If you own 20% of France, you would earn 59 points that round from France.
- Cumulative Points earned by you from France: 125 points

4.) **Quarterfinal:** France faces off with another quarterfinalist – let's say it ends up being Group A's second place Italy. Oh wait, they didn't qualify =)! Instead, its Korea making a Cinderella run. Korea has accumulated 230 points by this time. France wins and earns the sum total of its points plus those earned by Korea (295 + 230 = 525)

- Points earned by France in this Round: 525
- If you own 20% of France, you would earn 105 points that round from France.
- Cumulative Points earned by you from France: 230 points

5) **Semifinal:** France faces off with another semifinalist – let's say it ends up being Group H's winner Spain. Spain has accumulated 500 points by this time. France wins and earns the sum total of its points plus those earned by Spain (525 + 500 =1,025)

- Points earned by France in this Round: 1,025
- If you own 20% of France, you would earn 205 points that round from France.

- Cumulative Points earned by you from France: 435 points

6) **Final:** We have a World Cup Final 2022 rematch, France – Argentina. Through the tournament, Argentina has amassed 1000 points. France wins and earns the sum total of its points plus those earned by Argentina (1025+ 1000 = 2,025)

- Points earned by France in this Round: 1,025
- If you own 20% of France, you would earn 405 points that round from France.
- Cumulative Points earned by you from France: 840 points

A 20% owner in France would thus have earned 840 points through its ownership of France and would have collected each portion of those points after each victory (as would the other owners). Since you bet all of your money on France, this is the sum of all your points. If you spread out across multiple teams, we aggregate all of your points across the teams you own.

The trick is not just to identify who will win, but who you think has a chance to get significant investment from other players. Owning 100% or 50% of a team with a reasonable shot of getting out of the Group Stage may end up being worth more than owning 15-20% of a favorite to see the finals (then again, it may not...). Again, all bets are blind until locked in. All bets and money is due by 10am of first game day. Late bets or money won't be accepted. Once locked in, I'll post updates and pool summary so you can track how you're doing throughout the tournament. Winners will be determined and paid out after tournament completes.

Historically, we've had around 20-25 participants, so that should give you a sense of the size of the pool and the payouts. Speaking of payouts....

Winning the Pool

Winning the pool will be determined by the points you earn through your ownership of your teams you choose to bet on and aggregated across all the rounds. Payouts are:

Most Points: 60% of Pool

Pool Runner-up: 25% of Pool

Third Place: 10% of Pool

Last Place: 5% of Pool. **NOTE: Last place wins 5% of the Pool. Makes for some interesting strategizing!**

Sending Bets & Money by June 11 at 10 am ET

Send your bets to me by email (zfenn24@gmail.com), call/text (757-778-7003) or FB messenger.

Send your money to me via cash, venmo, paypal or Zelle.

Zachary Fenn

@Zachary-Fenn



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